

Nikita Sokolsky

Senior Software Engineer · Distributed systems, high-scale AWS infrastructure, AI-assisted development · 15 years of experience
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US Green Card holder, no sponsorship required · open to relocation anywhere in the US · available immediately

Summary

Backend and distributed systems engineer with 15 years in the industry, 8 of them at Amazon and AWS. Most recently a core engineer on the device data store that every Alexa device in the world reads from, including the infrastructure work that let Alexa+ ship. Before that, two years inside the AWS WAF request path, which evaluates security rules on billions of HTTP requests a day. Java, Rust, Go and Scala on the backend, React when the frontend needs it. Building with LLMs since mid-2022, before ChatGPT shipped. Certified Amazon Bar Raiser with 200+ interviews conducted and five years mentoring junior engineers. M.Sc. in Artificial Intelligence.

Experience

Career break · Apr 2026 – Jul 2026

Planned time off after eight years at Amazon, spent time building personal projects.

Amazon Web Services, Alexa AI · Seattle, WA

Software Development Engineer II, Alexa Device Intelligence · Nov 2024 – Apr 2026

Java, DynamoDB, Kinesis, Lambda, EC2

- Core engineer on the DynamoDB-backed store behind every Alexa device worldwide: device state, configuration and session data for hundreds of millions of endpoints at over 100,000 TPS, one of the largest stateful systems inside Amazon.
- Scaled the data layer for the Alexa+ launch, Amazon's generative-AI Alexa, which raised throughput, read-latency and consistency requirements on the store.
- Reworked read and write access patterns across the DynamoDB services to take hot-partition risk out of the peak device-traffic path.
- Reduced on-call load through failure-mode analysis, automated runbooks and CloudWatch alarms.

Amazon Web Services, AWS WAF · Seattle, WA

Software Development Engineer II, AWS Web Application Firewall · Nov 2022 – Nov 2024

Java, Rust, Kafka, Kinesis, EC2

- Halved p50 latency and raised throughput in the WAF request-processing pipeline, which enforces customer security rules on billions of HTTP and HTTPS requests a day across every AWS region.
- Brought Rust into the hot path of the rule-evaluation engine to replace Java bottlenecks. Fleet size for the service dropped to a third.
- Built and operated the Kafka (MSK) and Kinesis pipelines carrying real-time rule telemetry and customer log delivery.
- Worked with principal engineers on capacity planning and load-shedding strategy to hold sub-millisecond evaluation SLAs at peak traffic.

Flexport · Seattle, WA

Senior Software Engineer, Freight Forwarding Platform · Feb 2022 – Nov 2022

Scala, PostgreSQL (RDS), React

- Led design and delivery of the freight forwarding application that more than 2,000 Flexport cargo operators work in daily.
- Replaced a legacy monolith with event-driven Scala services on PostgreSQL (RDS). Reliability and deploy cadence both improved.
- Shipped the React frontend alongside product and design. Operators got through the same work faster than on the old tool.

Amazon Web Services, Networking · Seattle, WA

Software Development Engineer, AWS Networking · May 2021 – Feb 2022

Go, ECS, Lambda

- One of the first engineers on the service that shipped as [Amazon CloudWatch Internet Monitor](#), which scores internet availability and performance per client location and ISP for customer workloads on AWS.
- Designed the monitoring backend as event-driven Go services on Lambda and ECS, with automatic failover between regions.
- Carried it from scoping and system design through operational runbooks and the internal launch review.

Amazon, Business Payments · Seattle, WA

Software Development Engineer, Amazon Business Payments · May 2019 – May 2021

Java, EC2, Lambda

- Ran a multi-year platform refactor of invoice generation for Amazon Business customers.
- Broke a brittle monolithic billing pipeline into independently deployable services, each with its own metrics and alarms. Fault isolation improved and on-call burden dropped.
- Added regression test automation and monitoring dashboards so the team could ship faster with confidence.

Amazon, Business Credit · Vancouver, BC

Software Development Engineer, Amazon Business Credit Card · Jan 2018 – May 2019

Java, Spring, React, EC2, Lambda

- Delivered the Amazon Business credit card for small businesses, a partnership with American Express that launched on schedule in late 2018.
- Owned both sides of the product: React frontend and backend REST APIs.
- Wrote the UI and backend integration test suites from scratch.

Earlier experience

- **Moravia** · Brno, Czech Republic · Oct 2017 – Jan 2018. Software Development Consultant (C#, .NET, MVC). New workflow features and reliability work in an enterprise SaaS platform for corporate translation management.
- **ArexPharma GmbH** · Munich, Germany · Jun 2017 – Oct 2017. Software Development Consultant (C#, .NET, MVC). Rebuilt supplier workflows in a B2B marketplace for cross-border pharmaceutical trade in the EU.
- **ACTUM Digital** · Prague, Czech Republic · Nov 2016 – May 2017. Software Developer (Sitecore, C#, .NET). Enterprise client websites and production warranty support.
- **Creditinfo Solutions** · Prague, Czech Republic · Apr 2013 – Oct 2016. Software Developer, internal platforms (C#, .NET, SQL Server, Dynamics CRM). Owned the Dynamics CRM integration layer serving the company's global offices, working with product managers across several European locations.
- **moodAway** · London, UK, remote · Jun 2015 – Sep 2015. AngularJS frontend development.
- **Internships and freelance:** University of Paderborn GET Lab, Germany (2012), algorithms for the GetBot autonomous rescue robot · Lappeenranta University of Technology, Finland (2013) · freelance web app for visual analysis of commercial websites (2011).

Technical skills

- **Languages:** Java, Rust, Go, Scala, TypeScript, C#/.NET, SQL
- **AWS:** DynamoDB, Kinesis, MSK (Kafka), Lambda, EC2, ECS, S3, RDS, Elasticsearch, CloudWatch
- **Systems:** Distributed systems, event-driven architecture, stream processing, microservices, REST API design, capacity planning, load shedding, observability, on-call operations
- **AI:** LLM-assisted and agentic development (Cursor + custom harnesses), custom MCP tooling, RAG, prompt/context engineering
- **Data stores:** DynamoDB, PostgreSQL, SQL Server
- **Frontend:** React, TypeScript, AngularJS
- **Delivery:** CI/CD, GitHub Actions, automated testing, Cloudflare Workers
- **Spoken languages:** English, Russian and Czech, fluent in all three

Projects

sokolsky.me · May 2026 – present

- Personal site that has become my personal SaaS: tools built for my own needs, including a custom flight search engine and a custom hotel search engine. Full list at sokolsky.me/sitemap.
- 90 pages in ten weeks, built with heavy coding-agent assistance.

rankmyweather.com · July 2026

- Ranks world cities by how the weather actually feels outdoors. Five years of ERA5 hourly reanalysis, 1,826 days on a 0.25° global grid, reduced to daily Steadman apparent temperature and scored per urban center, behind an interactive map.

Recognition and mentoring

Amazon Bar Raiser. Certified to hold Amazon's hiring bar across all technical disciplines. 200+ interviews conducted, up to principal and senior principal level, across several AWS organizations.

Mentoring. Five years mentoring entry-level engineers at Amazon and AWS.

Education

M.Sc. in Artificial Intelligence · Czech Technical University in Prague · 2015 – 2017

B.Sc. in Computer Software Engineering · Czech Technical University in Prague · 2011 – 2014